PwC Digital Strategy

Actionable Insights from the Interview Evidence

Version 2, updated with Evidence Map v2 (follow-up Interview 09) | Partner-review draft | 31 October 2026

1. Version note, scope and limits

This is version 2 of the actionable insights pack. It supersedes version 1 (Actionable_Insights.docx), which is unchanged. Version 2 adds the follow-up evidence recorded in Evidence Map v2 (statements FU-01 to FU-26 from Interview 09, the client sponsor interview). No new data has been created. The three insights, original quotes and recommendations are carried over from version 1.

The original evidence is the eight interview transcripts and the reports built from them. Follow-up evidence is shaded orange and labelled "Int-09". Interview 09 is a fictional practice transcript, and the client sponsor is not one of stakeholders S1 to S8. The follow-up statements describe the client's process status and management's account of the target. None is independently verified.

Nothing here is a recommendation to proceed or not to proceed. "Evidence" means what stakeholders said. "Interpretation" is the consultant's reading of it. Quotes marked "(interview text)" are exact transcript quotes that are not in the earlier statement register.

Orange shading	Marks evidence or status from the follow-up interview (Int-09), using the FU IDs in Evidence Map v2. Unshaded text is from version 1.

2. What changed in version 2

Insight	Follow-up evidence added	Effect
Insight 1	Target now partly described (management account); alternatives lack criteria; customer contact restricted.	No change to the insight. Limitations and next-step status updated.
Insight 2	Nothing verified; data room not open; thresholds not approved; gate ownership expected, not agreed.	No change to the insight. Evidence standard shown as not yet met.
Insight 3	Regulatory pathway unconfirmed; no integration plan or stop authority; acquisition preference rests on an untested belief about speed.	No change to the insight. The conflict claim stays unvalidated.

3. Insights

Insight 1: Establish what the target is, and prove its advantage is real and exclusive, before valuation or timing work

What stakeholders said	The Chief Strategy Officer (S1) says the attraction of acquisition is speed. S1 also says the team has not yet shown what the target owns, or whether a partnership would work. Commercial, clinical, regulatory, technology and finance stakeholders (S2, S3, S4, S5, S6) each say their evidence needs depend on what the target is. Commercial and country stakeholders (S2, S8) say relationships may not transfer or may be personal.
What the evidence suggests	The transcripts do not say what the target is, where it operates or what it sells. The advantages S1 lists are only possible ones: an acquisition "might give us" them. This is the one point where the strategic case, by S1's own account, has not yet been established.
Why it may matter (interpretation)	If the target's advantage is not exclusive or does not transfer, the reason to acquire rather than partner or enter organically could weaken. Several other checks cannot be specified until the target's business model is known.

Supporting quotes and stakeholder IDs (original interviews)	S1: "we have not yet shown which of those advantages the target genuinely owns or whether we could achieve the same objective through a partnership." S1 (interview text): "the target's reputation and capabilities do not transfer to our intended markets" S2 (interview text): "That depends on the business model." S6 (interview text): "That depends on the target." S4 (interview text): "First, list the target's actual products and services and every country in which it operates or plans to enter." S8: "whether the relationships are institutional or personal."
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-01 (Int-09, Q1): "The target is a mid-sized medical technology company." FU-02 (Int-09, Q1): "It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them." FU-26 (Int-09, Q1): "It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B." FU-03 (Int-09, Q1): "That description comes from management's own presentation." FU-04 (Int-09, Q1): "We have not yet seen product-level detail, and I cannot yet tell you whether the platform is sold separately from the devices." FU-15 (Int-09, Q4): "We have not set criteria for comparing the three routes." FU-22 (Int-09, Q7): "Contact with the Target's customers is not permitted at this stage." What it adds: The target is now partly described, as management's account. Product-level detail has not been seen. No criteria exist for comparing the alternatives, and customer contact is not currently permitted. It adds no evidence on whether the advantage exists, is exclusive or transfers.
Contradictory evidence or limitations	No interviewee disputes this. Only S1 raises the alternatives of partnership and organic entry, so that point has one voice. Statements on transfer are conditional ("may", "if"), and none says the problem exists. There is no data on the target.
FOLLOW-UP LIMITATIONS (Int-09)	The description of the target comes only from management's presentation (FU-03) and has not been verified (FU-08, in Insight 2). Customer views cannot currently be gathered (FU-22), so transfer and exclusivity cannot yet be tested. Comparison criteria for acquisition, partnership and organic entry are not set (FU-15).
Recommended next step	Obtain the target's business description, product and country list. Then test exclusivity and transfer using contracts, change-of-control terms and customer references, and prepare the alternatives assessment S1 asks for.
FOLLOW-UP STATUS OF NEXT STEP (Int-09)	A business description has been provided as a management account (FU-01 to FU-03). It still needs verifying against source documents once the data room opens (FU-07). Customer references depend on the client lifting the current restriction (FU-22). The alternatives assessment still needs agreed criteria (FU-15).
Question a partner may ask	"If the target's advantage turned out not to be exclusive, what would be our reason to acquire rather than partner?"

Insight 2: Treat every management claim as untested, and agree one set of verification gates with the client

What stakeholders said	Stakeholders in strategy, commercial, clinical, regulatory, technology, finance and country roles (S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8) each ask for original or independently verified records in place of management assertions. Four stakeholders (S1, S3, S4, S6) also state conditions for pausing, escalating or qualifying the decision.
What the evidence suggests	The stakeholders agree on a standard of evidence. They do not report that any claim is false. They also describe gates in different terms: S1 pauses, S3 and S4 escalate for review, S6 allows a conditional recommendation. Whether any gate currently applies is not established in the transcripts.

Why it may matter (interpretation)	If gates are set separately by function, the same facts could be judged against different thresholds. Decision inputs such as quality, licences or revenue would then rest on claims no one has verified. S6 also says the client must supply explicit investment thresholds, and they have not yet been supplied.
Supporting quotes and stakeholder IDs (original interviews)	S1 (interview text): "We should show what we know, what management claims, and what remains untested." S3: "how quality is measured, over what period, against which comparator, and who independently verified the data" S4: "We should reconcile management's answers with original records." S5: "A policy document alone does not prove controls work." S6: "Reconcile reported revenue to contracts, invoices, cash collections and underlying activity." S6: "If critical assumptions cannot be validated, the recommendation may need to be conditional or the decision paused." S3: "should be escalated before commitment"
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-06 (Int-09, Q2): "Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview." FU-07 (Int-09, Q2): "The data room has not been opened to us yet." FU-08 (Int-09, Q2): "Nothing has been independently verified." FU-09 (Int-09, Q2): "So everything we currently believe about the Target is management's account." FU-10 (Int-09, Q3): "The board has not approved investment thresholds." FU-11 (Int-09, Q3): "I would expect the Chief Medical Officer and the Regulatory Director to be able to escalate a safety or compliance concern, and the CFO to own the financial gate." FU-12 (Int-09, Q3): "But that is my expectation. It has not been written down or agreed." FU-13 (Int-09, Q3 follow-up): "That has not been decided." FU-25 (Int-09, Q8): "If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed." What it adds: The client sponsor confirms that nothing has been independently verified and the data room is not yet open. Investment thresholds are not approved. Expected gate owners are named but not agreed, and whether escalation would stop the process is undecided. The evidence standard has not yet been met, and the follow-up verifies or refutes no claim.
Contradictory evidence or limitations	No interviewee contradicts this. S7 frames the need as definitions and trends rather than independent verification. The transcripts do not say what management has claimed, so the evidence describes how to test claims, not whether any are wrong. The differing gate framing may simply reflect different roles. It has not been established as a disagreement.
FOLLOW-UP LIMITATIONS (Int-09)	The follow-up statements describe the client's process status, not the target. They are stakeholder-reported and unverified. The expected gate owners in FU-11 are the CMO, the Regulatory Director and the CFO. They do not include a named owner for S1's pause criteria.
Recommended next step	Build an evidence register that separates verified facts, management claims and untested assumptions. Issue a data request for original records across regulatory, quality, data, contract and financial areas. Agree a single decision-gate framework and obtain the client's thresholds.
FOLLOW-UP STATUS OF NEXT STEP (Int-09)	The data request depends on the data room opening (FU-07). The gate framework needs to settle the investment thresholds (FU-10), gate ownership (FU-12) and the effect of escalation (FU-13).
Question a partner may ask	"Which of these gates would we treat as walk-away conditions, and who at the client decides?"

Insight 3: Do not rely on market size or a launch date. Model the access, approval and integration pathway country by country

What stakeholders said	Strategy, commercial, country and operations stakeholders (S1, S2, S8, S7) each say market growth or a large market does not show the target can capture or serve demand. The regulatory and country leads (S4, S8) say approvals, procurement and local steps could delay entry and should be in the forecast. The clinical, operations and technology leads (S3, S7, S5) warn that integration could disrupt continuity and safety.
What the evidence suggests	Stakeholders consistently describe market size, launch dates and integration as things to test, not assume. No timeline, forecast or capacity figure appears in the transcripts, so the speed rationale (S1) has not been tested against these constraints.
Why it may matter (interpretation)	A case built on market size and an assumed launch date could omit approval time, access barriers and safeguards on integration pace. Whether this would change the case, and by how much, is not established.
Supporting quotes and stakeholder IDs (original interviews)	S1: "A broad statement that healthcare demand is growing is not enough to justify this target or its valuation." S2: "Market growth does not automatically become revenue for one company." S8: "Do not equate a large healthcare market with an accessible market." S4: "We must not assume one country's approval works everywhere." S4: "The forecast should model the relevant pathway, not simply assume a launch date." S7: "A market forecast does not tell us whether the target can safely deliver the extra demand." S7: "Changing suppliers, systems, processes or leadership too quickly can disrupt availability, care workflows, service levels or quality."
FOLLOW-UP INTERVIEW EVIDENCE (Int-09)	FU-05 (Int-09, Q1 follow-up): "Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B." FU-24 (Int-09, Q8): "The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed." FU-19 (Int-09, Q5): "We have not decided whether to integrate the Target's platform into our systems or keep it separate." FU-20 (Int-09, Q6): "There is no integration plan." FU-21 (Int-09, Q6): "Authority to stop a change is not defined." FU-16 (Int-09, Q4): "At the moment the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, and nobody has put a timeline against each option." What it adds: The regulatory pathway for Market B is not confirmed, and the decision date is not fixed. There is no integration plan and no defined authority to stop a change. The client sponsor says the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, with no timeline per option.
Contradictory evidence or limitations	None found. The tension between S1's "speed" and the delay and pace points is a consultant inference and is unvalidated. S1's speed refers to market entry, whereas S7's caution refers to integration pace, so they may not conflict. The statements are general. Which countries, products and customers are in scope is not established.
FOLLOW-UP LIMITATIONS (Int-09)	FU-16 supports the narrower claim that the speed advantage has not been tested. It does not show that speed conflicts with approval or integration constraints, which remains unvalidated. No timelines, forecasts or capacity figures are given in the follow-up.
Recommended next step	Once the target's footprint is known, map licences and approvals by country with legal and regulatory specialists. Build a comparative timeline for acquisition, partnership and organic entry. Define Day 1 safeguards: what must stay stable, who can stop an unsafe change, and the continuity plan.
FOLLOW-UP STATUS OF NEXT STEP (Int-09)	The approval pathway for Market B is not yet confirmed (FU-05). No timelines or criteria for the three entry routes exist yet (FU-15, FU-16). The integration plan and stop authority are currently undefined (FU-20, FU-21).

Question a partner may ask	"What evidence would make us comfortable that speed is real, and not just an assumption in the model?"

4. The three most decision-relevant insights

All three are supported only as stakeholder opinion, and none supports a recommendation on its own. The order reflects dependency, not how often a point was raised. Insight 1 comes first because the others cannot be specified without it.

1. **Establish the target and its exclusive advantage (Insight 1).** This is the thesis itself, and S1 says it is not yet shown.
2. **Verify claims and agree decision gates (Insight 2).** This determines what evidence the committee can rely on.
3. **Model the access, approval and integration pathway (Insight 3).** This determines whether the speed rationale and forecast hold.

Follow-up (Int-09): The follow-up does not change this order. For each insight it confirms that the evidence is not yet in place: the target is described only by management (FU-03), nothing is verified (FU-08), and the regulatory pathway, integration plan and route comparison are undefined (FU-05, FU-20, FU-15).

5. Claims that require validation, with follow-up status

Claim	Follow-up status (Int-09)
That a speed advantage from acquisition exists, and its size (unvalidated).	Client sponsor describes it as a belief that has not been tested (FU-16).
That the target genuinely owns any advantage listed by S1, and that it is exclusive.	No follow-up evidence.
That acquisition is better than partnership or organic entry (S1 says this has not been shown).	Both routes remain open (FU-14). No comparison criteria are set (FU-15).
That relationships and reputation transfer across borders and survive a change of ownership.	No follow-up evidence. Customer contact is not permitted at this stage (FU-22).
That the target is "high quality", or that any safety, quality, regulatory or conduct issue does or does not exist.	No follow-up evidence. Nothing has been independently verified (FU-08).
That the target holds the licences and approvals it needs in each country.	The regulatory pathway for Market B is not confirmed (FU-05).
That the target's data and cyber controls are adequate, if it holds health data at all.	Management's description says the platform collects data from the devices (FU-02). Data rights, storage and cross-border flow are unknown (FU-18).
That reported revenue is reliable, and that the headline valuation covers all costs and liabilities.	Summary financial information has been received (FU-06) but nothing is verified (FU-08). Thresholds are not approved (FU-10).
That the target has payer or reimbursement exposure (conditional in S2 and S6).	No follow-up evidence.
That the target can scale safely to meet forecast demand.	No follow-up evidence.
That speed conflicts with approval and integration constraints (a consultant inference, unvalidated).	Remains unvalidated. Only the narrower claim that speed is untested is supported (FU-16).
That any of the gate conditions stated by S1, S3, S4 or S6 currently applies.	No follow-up evidence. Gate owners are expected but not agreed (FU-11, FU-12).
NEW: That management's description of the target (two lines of connected devices and a cloud monitoring platform, operating in Market A) is accurate.	Unverified. It is management's account (FU-02, FU-03, FU-26), and nothing is independently verified (FU-08).

Each original claim is also listed as "Not established in transcript" in the earlier reports. The claim marked NEW arises from the follow-up.

Appendix: Follow-up statements cited

Quotes are verbatim from the Interview 09 transcript, using the same FU IDs as Evidence Map v2.

ID	Question	Exact quote	Type
FU-01	Q1	"The target is a mid-sized medical technology company."	Management account, unverified
FU-02	Q1	"It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them."	Management account, unverified
FU-03	Q1	"That description comes from management's own presentation."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-04	Q1	"We have not yet seen product-level detail, and I cannot yet tell you whether the platform is sold separately from the devices."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-05	Q1 follow-up	"Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-06	Q2	"Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-07	Q2	"The data room has not been opened to us yet."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-08	Q2	"Nothing has been independently verified."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-09	Q2	"So everything we currently believe about the Target is management's account."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-10	Q3	"The board has not approved investment thresholds."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-11	Q3	"I would expect the Chief Medical Officer and the Regulatory Director to be able to escalate a safety or compliance concern, and the CFO to own the financial gate."	Stakeholder expectation (hypothesis)
FU-12	Q3	"But that is my expectation. It has not been written down or agreed."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-13	Q3 follow-up	"That has not been decided."	Stakeholder-reported status (answer to whether CMO or Regulatory escalation would stop the process)
FU-14	Q4	"Both are still open in principle."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-15	Q4	"We have not set criteria for comparing the three routes."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-16	Q4	"At the moment the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, and nobody has put a timeline against each option."	Stakeholder-reported belief and status
FU-18	Q5	"We do not know what rights the Target has over that data, where it is stored, or whether it crosses borders."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-19	Q5	"We have not decided whether to integrate the Target's platform into our systems or keep it separate."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-20	Q6	"There is no integration plan."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-21	Q6	"Authority to stop a change is not defined."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-22	Q7	"Contact with the Target's customers is not permitted at this stage."	Stakeholder-reported status
FU-24	Q8	"The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed."	Stakeholder-reported plan
FU-25	Q8	"If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed."	Stakeholder preference (opinion)
FU-26	Q1	"It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B."	Management account, unverified